



KENYA INSTITUTE OF CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

Core Competencies for Basic Education

Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development





INTRODUCTION



What is a competency?

Competency is *‘the ability to apply appropriate knowledge, skills, values and attitudes to successfully perform a function’.*

The curriculum is designed to emphasize the importance of developing skills and knowledge, attitudes and values and also applying these to real life situations.





THE SEVEN CORE COMPETENCIES



BECF seeks to develop these competencies so that all Kenyans can thrive in the 21st century.

1. **Communication and Collaboration**
2. **Self-efficacy**
3. **Critical Thinking and Problem Solving**
4. **Creativity and Imagination**
5. **Citizenship**
6. **Digital Literacy**
7. **Learning to Learn**





1. COMMUNICATION AND COLLABORATION

Communication is the act of transferring information from one place to another, whether vocally, visually, or non-verbally.

Collaboration is the process of two or more people or organizations working together to realize shared goals.

A learner with the competence in communication and collaboration skills can:

Indicators

- Collegially work in teamwork with others
- Clearly and presentably express his or her needs and wants
- Express and argue out opinion
- Defend his or her views,
- Share out knowledge/resources and seek knowledge/resources from others
- Justify course or action taken.





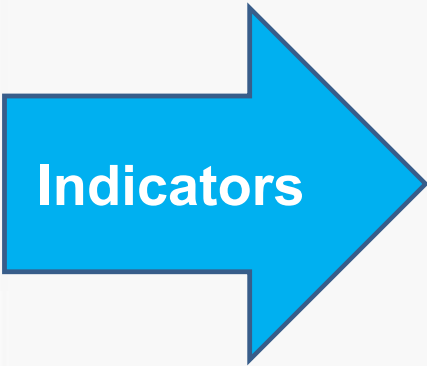
2. SELF-EFFICACY

Self-efficacy is a person's belief about his or her capabilities to perform tasks or assignments that can change and transform his or her life.

A strong sense of self-efficacy enhances a learner's accomplishment and personal well-being in many ways.

A learner with the competence in self-efficacy can:

- **Present ideas with confidence**
- **Demonstrate sense of assurance and trust**
- **Present self-interest, group interest and or defend opinions**
- **Volunteer to undertake challenging tasks**
- **Courageously volunteer to take group leadership**
- **Demonstrate intrinsic self-motivation**
- **Demonstrate self-awareness, responsibility, resource care and age-related chore management**
- **Confidently protect and conserve personal and group resources.**



Indicators





3. CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

Critical thinking is the use logic and evidence to arrive at conclusions.

Critical thinking and problem solving are developed through age appropriate activities and programmes in the school curriculum.

A learner with critical thinking and problem-solving skills can:

- Demonstrate objective ideas, opinions and view
- Make objective evidence-based conclusion
- Justify course and action taken
- Explore new ways of doing common chores
- Innovate to solve age-based problems
- Demonstrate autonomy in exploring ideas, seeking solutions and implementing ideas to solve a contextual problem

Indicators





Continued...

...3. CRITICAL THINKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING



A learner with critical thinking and problem-solving skills can...

Indicators

- Demonstrates open mind to new ideas and opinions
- Adopts multifaceted dimensions and makes multiple attempts to solving a contextual issue
- Makes critical observations and deduces objective conclusions
- Makes critical hypothesis and attempts resolutions to a problem
- Gives objective ideas to solving a contextual problem.
- Seek assistance in critical needs.

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4. CREATIVITY AND IMAGINATION

Creativity and imagination refers to the ability of learners and their teachers to form images and ideas in their minds, and turn them into real, visible creations.

Learners are able to use the knowledge, skills and values acquired in the learning process to create new ideas that result in products that add value to their lives and to the lives of others around them.

A learner with creativity and imagination skills can:

- Form and communicates/presents ideas (writing, sketching, gestures)
- Translate ideas to real items (drawing, sculpture, model, design)
- Present multiple dimensions to a single idea
- Compile other people's ideas to a concrete image
- Compile ideas to develop a concept
- Patch-up ideas to a concrete course/solution/concept.
- Analyse a broad idea to component ideas
- Innovate a model/item from own or others ideas.

Indicators

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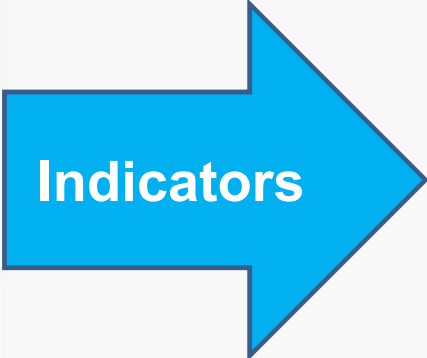


5. CITIZENSHIP

Citizenship is the state of being vested with the rights, privileges, and duties of a citizen. A sense of citizenship helps to equip young people to deal with situations of conflict and controversy knowledgeably and tolerantly.

A learner with competence in citizenship shows the following:

- Values a sense of identity with others
- Upholds identity with peers
- Respects and upholds rights of others
- Operates within own rights
- Responsibly claims his or her own rights and privileges
- Undertakes duties and obligations
- Expresses own belonging among others
- Seeks peace while resolving conflicts with others
- Demonstrates tolerance in resolving controversies
- Demonstrates some level of understanding when own rights/privileges are infringed.



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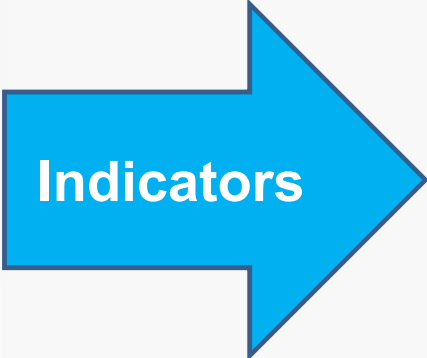
6. DIGITAL LITERACY

Digital literacy can be described as having the knowledge, skills and behaviours which are necessary to effectively and safely use a wide range of digital content and devices.

It is considered as one of the main core competencies for learning and life in the 21st century.

A learner with digital literacy skills can:

- use digital device communication networks,
- engage in online communication and social networks,
- being aware of and adhering to ethical behaviour protocols,
- being aware of societal issues raised through digital media,
- search, evaluate and use information channelled through digital platforms,
- safely and securely use technology.



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7. LEARNING TO LEARN

Learning is a continuous process that begins at birth and continues until death...

Learning to learn is the ability to pursue and persist in learning, to organise one's own learning by the effective management of time and information, both individually and in groups.

A learner with skills in learning to learn can:

- show openness to new ideas
- critique his or her own ideas
- use one idea as a learning experience to a new idea
- use new opportunities as a learning experience to expound knowledge and skills
- continuously demonstrate personality progress
- progressively adopt new value, beliefs and opinion structures

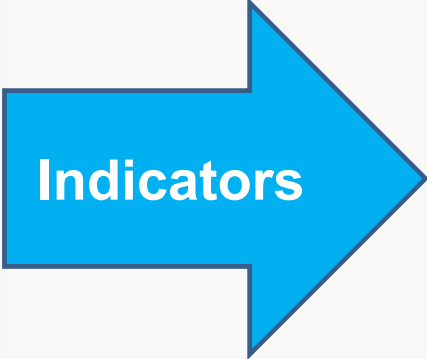
Indicators

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...7. LEARNING TO LEARN

A learner with skills in learning to learn can...

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Indicators

- persistently pursue new targets and more challenging goals
- work progressively to overcome existing obstacles
- seek assistance and guidance to overcome persistent obstacles
- adopt and assimilate new knowledge and skills to overcome contextual challenges.



Example in Integration of Core competencies

To develop a communication and collaboration in the learning process, the teacher should facilitate the following:

Assign activity to interpret and express themselves

Expose the learners to reading and open dialogue

Assign activity to presentations and listening sessions

Facilitate session to critique presentation

Activities





CONCLUSION

- The seven core competencies are to be learnt in all the learning areas.
- Learning areas have different capacities to integrate and develop each of the seven core competencies.

Examples;

- Languages readily integrate communication and collaboration.
- Creative learning areas readily integrate creativity and imagination.
- Science based learning areas are more open to integrate critical thinking and problem solving.
- Social studies is highly potent to integrate citizenship.



Thank you

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